

» SQUIRRELS AND CHIPMUNKS



17–27 cm
6½–10½ in

GAMBIAN SUN SQUIRREL

Heliosciurus gambianus

A common species in savanna woodlands across Africa, from Senegal to Zimbabwe, this squirrel feeds mainly on the seeds of Acacia trees.

long,
bushy tail



CAPE GROUND SQUIRREL

Geosciurus inauris

This coarsely haired squirrel escapes the extreme temperatures of the semi-deserts of South Africa by sheltering in burrows.

15–20 cm
6–8 in



COLUMBIAN GROUND SQUIRREL

Urocyon columbianus

A rather large, bushy tailed ground squirrel, this species forms colonies in meadows and forest edges from Idaho, USA, north into W. Canada.

GOLDEN-MANTLED GROUND SQUIRREL

Callospermophilus lateralis

Appearing like a larger version of the chipmunk, this species is a common sight in forests and mountains of the W. USA.

22–28 cm
9–11 in

12–15 cm
4¾–6 in



HOPi CHIPMUNK

Tamias rufus

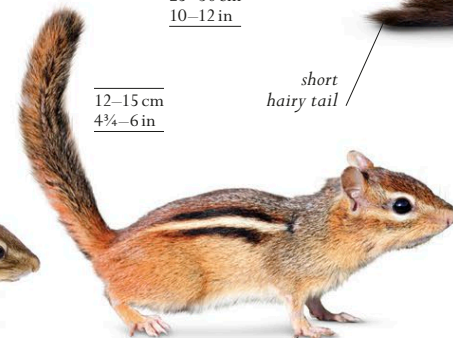
Chipmunks from different parts of N. America form separate species. This species occurs in Utah, Colorado, and adjacent parts of Arizona.

EASTERN CHIPMUNK

Tamias striatus

This striped, ground-living species is a common sight in forest campgrounds of the E. USA, where it has become quite tame.

12–15 cm
4¾–6 in



short
hairy tail

BEAVERS

There are only two species of beavers in the family Castoridae. Both are exploited for their fur. One is widespread across North America, and the other in patches throughout most of Europe. Both build dams out of stones, mud, and trees, creating habitats for other species.

BEAVER

Castor sp.

European and N. American beavers are different species, but both live a similar, semi-aquatic life in rivers and lakes.

0.8–1.2 m
2½–4 ft

flat, scaly tail



glossy,
brown fur

GOPHERS

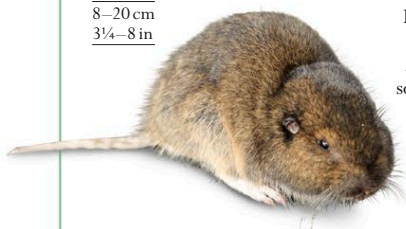
Members of the family Geomyidae, found in North America, live alone in shallow burrows that allow them to access roots and leaves. They carry their food in cheek pouches and store it in underground chambers.

8–20 cm
3¼–8 in

BOTTA'S POCKET GOPHER

Thomomys bottae

A small burrowing creature of soft soil and grassy areas, this species digs up mounds of earth, which can damage farm machinery.



DORMICE

The Gliridae occur in wooded habitats across Europe, sub-Saharan Africa, and patchily in Central Asia, with a single species in Japan. Resembling small nocturnal squirrels, all but one are soft-furred, arboreal species. Many are threatened or are declining in numbers.

AFRICAN DORMOUSE

Graphiurus sp.

There are 15 species of African dormice. They are all similar in appearance and inhabit forested areas of sub-Saharan Africa.

bushy tail

7–15 cm
2¾–6 in

